

REPORT

Activities and Functions of the Department of Statistics

Under the Government of Kerala and Government of India

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1. Introduction

Statistics plays an important role in planning, administration, economic development and policy formulation. In India, statistical activities are carried out at both the State and Central levels. In Kerala, the Department of Economics and Statistics (DES) functions as the nodal statistical agency of the State, while at the national level, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) coordinates the official statistical system of India.

2. Department of Economics and Statistics, Government of Kerala

The Department of Economics and Statistics is responsible for the systematic **collection, compilation, analysis, interpretation and dissemination of statistical information** relating to different sectors of Kerala's economy. Its objective is to provide timely, reliable and credible statistics for government planning and decision-making.

The department conducts various **censuses, sample surveys and socio-economic studies** covering areas such as agriculture, industry, employment, prices, population and household conditions. It also undertakes surveys for other government departments according to their requirements. These activities provide important information for development planning and estimation of economic indicators.

An important function of the department is the collection of **price statistics**, including farm, wholesale and retail prices. These data are used for preparing price indices, monitoring market conditions and supporting government decisions related to procurement and economic policy.

The department also publishes statistical reports and bulletins and makes statistical information available to government departments, researchers and the public. Its statistical system operates through the Directorate, **14 District Statistical Offices and 61 Taluk Statistical Offices**, along with statistical cells in various government departments.

3. Statistical Activities under the Government of India

At the national level, the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** is the nodal ministry responsible for the planned and organized development of India's statistical system. It coordinates statistical activities among Central Ministries, State Governments and other agencies.

The **National Statistical Office (NSO)** produces major official statistics, including

National Accounts, Gross Domestic Product (GDP), Index of Industrial Production (IIP) and other important economic and social indicators.

The NSO also conducts large-scale nationwide sample surveys on subjects such as employment, consumer expenditure, health, education, housing and other socio-economic conditions. These surveys provide important data for understanding the social and economic conditions of the country.

MoSPI establishes statistical standards, concepts, classifications and methodologies and works to improve the quality, reliability and timeliness of official statistics. It also disseminates statistical information through publications and digital platforms such as **eSankhyiki**, which provides access to datasets and macroeconomic indicators.

The Programme Implementation Wing of MoSPI also monitors major infrastructure projects and their implementation. The Infrastructure and Project Monitoring Division monitors major projects and the performance of important infrastructure sectors.

4. Conclusion

Thus, the statistical departments of Kerala and the Government of India form an important part of the country's information system. Through surveys, censuses, data collection, analysis, publication and monitoring, they provide reliable evidence for **economic planning, public administration, research and development programmes**.

The activities of these departments help governments understand social and economic conditions and make decisions based on statistical evidence. Therefore, official statistics play an essential role in effective governance and sustainable development.

5. References

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